

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 16th August 2026

Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

“Woman, you have great faith”

The Canaanite woman in the Gospel appears almost to be the opposite of Peter from last week whom Jesus accused of having little faith. As an outsider, she comes to him with a mother’s urgent prayer: “Lord, help me.” At first her plea seems to meet silence and resistance. Yet she does not walk away: she remains humble, courageous, and persistent, trusting that even the smallest share in God’s mercy is enough to bring healing.

Her faith it is not loud in a demanding entitled way. She displays a strong faith in the sense of refusing to give up on Jesus. She, an outsider, recognises him as Lord and places before him the suffering of someone she loves. Many of us will know something of that prayer: the prayer made beside a hospital bed, for a family member in difficulty, for a child who has lost their way, or for a burden that we carry that seems slow to lift.

Jesus’ final words to her are full of hope: “Woman, you have great faith.” The Gospel reminds us that God’s mercy is wider than our boundaries. The first reading speaks of God’s house as “a house of prayer for all peoples,” and the Gospel shows that promise beginning to unfold in the life of Christ. No one who turns to the Lord with faith is beyond his compassion.

This Gospel is both comforting and challenging. It comforts us by teaching us to persevere in prayer, even when answers seem delayed. It challenges us to become a community where those who feel distant, overlooked, or outside the usual circle can still encounter welcome, dignity, and mercy. This week, let us pray with the Canaanite woman’s simple words: “Lord, help me.” And let us ask for the grace to see others with the generous heart of Christ.

We pray for **Maureen McCauley** of Camelia Court and **David Phillips** of Chapel Road both of whom were buried following Requiem Masses on Saturday

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Celine Friel, Jim Quigley, Ethna McGrath, John Minahan, Tommy McNaught, Helen Cairns, Terry Doherty.

Vocations – We pray for the men called to priesthood. That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples." For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention and everyone welcome.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,080.00 Strathfoyle: £660.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

***"He who sings, prays twice."* (St Augustine)** – St Columb's church choir is on its summer break for the months of **July & August** and will resume in September. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Marcus or any choir members.

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours pw), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24th August 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. September 25th/26th 2026 – November 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

The Churches Trust are currently recruiting for our Community Support Service based in the city. This service provides much needed befriending for elderly living independently at home. Flexible Part-Time Work as a Personal Assistant We're looking for caring, reliable individuals to join our panel of self-employed personal assistants. Set your own hours. Earn extra income. Make a difference in your community No experience required, we provide training and support. Applicants should have full, clean driving license and access to a vehicle. Apply today and start helping those in need. Call 028 71311322 for more info.

Rosary on the beach taking place this Sunday 16th August at 3.00pm at Benone

Exam results time We remember in prayer in a special way those in our parish who have or are receiving exam results around this time and are making decisions on their future.

Holy Spirit source of wisdom and truth
Guide my thoughts words and actions

Help me to discern God's will in all things for my future. Give me courage to follow the path you place before me and the grace to trust in your direction.
Lead me always closer to Christ. Amen

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)

St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)
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Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

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Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.
